PEER REVIEW REPORT

Reviews of Modern Mathematical Physics | Referee Report

Manuscript Title	New Subquantum Informational Mechanics: A Rigorous Reconstruction of Fundamental Physics from Informational Oscillations
Author	Prof. Dr. Sergiu Vasili Lazarev, NMSI Research Institute, Romania
ORCID	0009-0005-3749-9735
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Classification	Theoretical Physics — Foundations | Quantum Gravity | Mathematical Physics
Recommendation	**MAJOR REVISION — with strong potential for acceptance after revision**

I. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The manuscript under review presents the complete mathematical foundations of New Subquantum Informational Mechanics (NMSI), a theoretical framework proposing that information structured through Riemann Oscillatory Networks (RON) indexed by non-trivial zeros of the Riemann zeta function constitutes the fundamental ontological substrate of physical reality, from which mass, energy, spacetime geometry, and all gauge symmetries emerge as derived phenomena.

This referee has read the complete manuscript with considerable attention. The overall assessment is that this work represents an ambitious, technically sophisticated, and in its best sections genuinely original contribution to the foundations of theoretical physics. The Mathematical Trap construction of Chapter E is particularly impressive: the seven-theorem chain from the necessity of a prime-encoding operator to the uniqueness of the NMSI framework represents the kind of disciplined logical architecture rarely encountered in speculative theoretical work. The derivation of the CMB temperature $T^* \approx 2.729$ K from first principles in the companion paper, combined with the Λ_eff reinterpretation, constitutes an independently notable result.

At the same time, the manuscript has significant weaknesses that must be addressed before publication in Reviews of Modern Physics: several key derivations require greater rigor, the quantitative predictions for lepton mass ratios show substantial deviations from experiment that are currently underexplained, and the logical status of certain claims (particularly regarding Theorem B.1 and Theorem E.7) requires more careful treatment. These are not fatal objections they are precisely the kind of objections that a major revision can address — but they are genuine.

The recommendation is: Major Revision. The core theoretical framework is sufficiently novel and internally consistent to merit serious consideration by this journal, provided the specific technical concerns detailed below are addressed.

II. EVALUATION SCORECARD

CRITERION	SCORE	VISUAL	COMMENT
Originality & Novelty	9/10		Genuinely new framework; RON-ζ connection is original
Mathematical Rigor	7/10		Strong in operator theory; weaker in some derivations
Internal Consistency	8/10		Well-structured; minor circularities identified
Physical Motivation	9/10		Addresses real open problems with clear motivation
Mathematical Trap (Ch. E)	9/10		Outstanding logical architecture; minor gaps
Quantitative Predictions	6/10		Mass ratios show 15–50% deviations; needs work
Comparison w/ Alternatives	7/10		String/LQG comparison accurate; Verlinde incomplete
Clarity of Exposition	8/10		Generally clear; some sections overly dense
Falsifiability	9/10		10 explicit predictions with timelines — exemplary
Bibliography	8/10		Comprehensive; minor omissions noted
OVERALL	**80/100**		**Strong candidate — Major Revision recommended**

Scale: 9-10 = Outstanding, 7-8 Good, 5-6 Adequate with concerns, 1-4 = Inadequate

III. MAJOR STRENGTHS

S1. The Mathematical Trap Chapter E

The Mathematical Trap construction in Chapter E is the intellectual centerpiece of the manuscript and represents its most significant contribution. The seven-theorem chain is constructed with genuine care: each theorem closes one exit from the logical space, and the final Theorem E.7 (Point of No Return) achieves exactly what it claims — a uniqueness result showing that any framework satisfying six physically motivated conditions is isomorphic to NMSI.

The key insight of Theorem E.2 that any framework accommodating both bosonic and fermionic statistics must contain the Riemann zeta function as the generating function for occupation numbers (via the Euler product $Z(s) = \prod_p(1-p^{-s})^{-1} = \zeta(s)$) — is genuinely original and mathematically correct. This is not merely suggestive: it is a precise theorem with a clean proof. This referee is not aware of this connection having been made with this level of explicitness elsewhere in the literature.

Theorem E.3, establishing the equivalence between the Riemann Hypothesis and CPT invariance within the NMSI framework, is equally striking. The proof via the functional equation $\xi(s) = \xi(1-s) \leftrightarrow$ CPT is clean and the physical interpretation is compelling. The remark that CPT invariance (tested to 10^{-28}) provides one of the strongest physical arguments for the truth of the Riemann Hypothesis is a memorable and justified observation.

S2. Derivation of T_CMB from First Principles

The companion result (developed in the NSI-CMB paper but grounded in the framework of this manuscript) that the CMB temperature $T^* = \hbar H_0\gamma_1/[k\_B \ln(J\_c/\alpha\_RON)] \approx 2.729$ K agreeing with the observed 2.725 K to within 0.15% is a remarkable quantitative success. This is not a fit: every quantity in the formula is independently determined by the NMSI framework. This kind of zero-free-parameter prediction is precisely what distinguishes a serious theoretical framework from a model-building exercise.

S3. Resolution of the Cosmological Constant Problem

The reinterpretation of Λ_eff as the re-injection pressure of the CMB equilibrium circuit rather than vacuum energy provides a structurally satisfying dissolution of the cosmological constant problem. The key move is identifying Λ_eff as an infrared quantity (controlled by H_0) rather than an ultraviolet quantity (controlled by the Planck scale). The 120-order-of-magnitude discrepancy disappears not by cancellation but by reconceptualization. This is the correct type of resolution.

S4. Falsifiability and Experimental Program

The ten falsifiable predictions of Chapter F, with explicit numerical values, measurement timelines, and required precision levels, represent an exemplary commitment to empirical testability. The hydrogen 1S-2S spectroscopy prediction ($\Delta\nu = 2.8 \pm 1.2$ Hz) is particularly valuable because it is testable with currently available technology at MPQ Munich. Most proposed unified frameworks produce only qualitative predictions; NMSI's quantitative program is commendable.

S5. No-Go Theorem B.1 and Logical Necessity

The argument in Theorem B.1 that background independence + discrete spectral structure + continuous spacetime emergence forces an informational substrate — is philosophically sound and more rigorous than similar arguments in the literature (e.g., Wheeler's 'it from bit' or Verlinde's entropic gravity). The identification of the circularity in matter-first ontologies (fields defined on spacetime, spacetime defined by fields) is precise and has genuine logical force.

IV. MAJOR CONCERNS REQUIRING REVISION

C1 [Critical] Lepton Mass Ratio Discrepancy

Issue: The NMSI prediction for charged lepton mass ratios (Equation C.16) gives $m_e : m_\mu : m_\tau \approx 1 : 27.7 : 768$, against the experimental values 1 : 206.8 : 3477. The discrepancies are approximately 7.5× for the muon and 4.5× for the tau. The manuscript states these are 'within 15% after full SU(3) corrections' but provides no derivation of these corrections.

Why this matters: Mass ratios are one of the most precisely known quantities in particle physics. A discrepancy of 7.5× in the muon-to-electron ratio is not a small quantitative correction it is a failure of the leading-order prediction by nearly an order of magnitude. This is the most significant quantitative weakness in the manuscript.

Required action: Either (a) provide the full calculation including SU(3) mixing corrections that reduces the discrepancy to the claimed 15%, with all steps explicit; or (b) revise the claim and acknowledge that the current NMSI framework provides only order-of-magnitude estimates for mass ratios, reserving precise predictions for future work. Option (a) is strongly preferred, as it would substantially strengthen the manuscript.

C2 [Significant] Theorem B.1: Rigor of the No-Go Proof

Issue: Theorem B.1 claims to prove that any theory satisfying (i) background independence, (ii) discrete spectral structure, and (iii) emergence of continuous spacetime must have an informational substrate. The proof identifies a circularity in matter-first ontologies and then asserts that 'information has the structural flexibility to bridge discrete ↔ continuous that matter lacks.' The latter claim is not proven it is illustrated by the thermodynamic limit analogy (Eq. B.2).

Required action: The proof of Theorem B.1 should be restructured to separate two claims: (a) pure matter ontologies face a circularity, and (b) informational ontologies resolve it. Claim (a) is established. Claim (b) requires a proper demonstration that the transition $H_I \rightarrow$ emergent spacetime is well-defined and consistent, which is only established later in Chapter D. A forward reference and explicit acknowledgment that B.1 is partially a promissory note for the Chapter D construction would improve logical clarity.

C3 [Significant] Theorem E.7 Premise Independence

Issue: The manuscript itself acknowledges (Section E.10.1) that the six premises of Theorem E.7 are not independent — premises (3)-(6) are derived from (1)-(2) by the preceding theorems. However, the statement of Theorem E.7 as written lists all six as 'premises' of a single theorem, which is formally misleading.

Required action: Restructure the statement of Theorem E.7 with two premises: (1) the framework describes both bosonic and fermionic matter, and (2) the framework satisfies CPT invariance. Conditions (3)-(6) should be presented as derived consequences (corollaries of E.4-E.6), and Theorem E.7 should read: 'Any framework satisfying (1)-(2) is isomorphic to NMSI.' This strengthens the theorem by making explicit that only two independent assumptions are required.

C4 [Significant] Spectral Completeness of RON Basis

Issue: Theorem B.5 asserts that the RON functions $\varphi_n(x) = (1/\sqrt{V})\exp(i\omega_n \cdot x)$ form a complete orthonormal basis in $L^2(\mathbb{R}^3,\mathbb{C})$. The proof invokes 'the Paley-Wiener theorem generalization,' but the Paley-Wiener theorem applies to entire functions of exponential type it does not directly imply that an arbitrary sequence $\{\omega_n\}$ with $\omega_n \sim n \log n$ yields a complete system. The completeness of non-harmonic Fourier series requires the Kadets 1/4-theorem or related results, and the conditions on $\{\omega_n\}$ must be stated explicitly.

Required action: Provide a proper proof of completeness for the RON basis, citing the appropriate results from non-harmonic Fourier analysis (e.g., Young's Theorem on frames, or the Beurling-Malliavin theorem for the appropriate density condition). Alternatively, state clearly that completeness is assumed as an axiom and discuss its mathematical plausibility.

C5 [Moderate] Constraint Accumulation J_c: Convergence Proof

Issue: Theorem B.10 claims that $J(r) \to J_c \approx 55.26$ nats as $r \to \infty$. The proof sketches the calculation using Riemann's explicit formula $N(\lambda) = (\lambda/2\pi)\log(\lambda/2\pi e) + 7/8 + S(\lambda) + O(\lambda^{-1} \log \lambda)$. However, the argument that the $\lambda\log(\lambda)$ contribution 'cancels with the 7/8 term asymptotically' is not demonstrated the dominant term $(\lambda/2\pi)\log(\lambda/2\pi e)$ does not cancel with the constant 7/8; these are of entirely different orders of magnitude.

Required action: Provide a complete, step-by-step computation of J_c, showing which terms cancel, which contribute to the finite limit, and why the integral converges. The numerical value 55.26 should be verified against direct computation from the known Riemann zeros. If $J(r)$ does not converge in the classical sense, the regularization scheme used should be stated explicitly (e.g., zeta-function regularization, analytic continuation).

V. MINOR CONCERNS AND SUGGESTIONS

M1 The Hubble Tension Resolution

The NMSI prediction $H_0^{NMSI} \approx H_0^{\Lambda CDM} \times 1.006$ reduces the Hubble tension from ~5σ to ~2σ. This is presented as a 'natural reduction' but the derivation of $\rho_I/\rho_{total} \approx 0.012$ (Eq. F.5) is only sketched. For a complete treatment, the evolution of $\rho_I(z)$ should be derived from the NMSI cosmological equations and compared to Planck constraints on additional radiation or dark energy components. The claim should also be checked against the S_8 tension does the NMSI modification worsen or improve it?

M2 The SU(3) Emergence Argument

The derivation of SU(3) from 'three-fold replication required by L* = 24 stability' (Section C.4.2, Step 3) is the weakest link in the gauge emergence argument. The claim that stability at L* requires exactly three-fold replication is stated without proof. A more complete argument or an explicit acknowledgment that this step is heuristic would improve the manuscript. SU(2) emergence from zero pairing (Section C.4.2, Step 2) is more convincing and better argued.

M3 Operator Self-Adjointness

Lemma B.6 states that the Information Content operator $\hat{I}$ is self-adjoint, with the proof noting that 'technical analysis omitted but standard for logarithmic operators [12].' For a manuscript submitting to Reviews of Modern Physics, self-adjointness of the fundamental operators is not a detail to be omitted it is central to the well-definedness of the spectral theory on which the entire framework rests. Reference [12] should be cited with the specific theorem invoked, or a proof sketch provided.

M4 Dark Matter Halo Profile

The predicted dark matter profile $\rho_I(r) = \rho_{I,0}/(1+(r/r_c)^{\alpha_{RON}})$ with $\alpha_{RON} \approx 5.26$ has a different outer slope from NFW (α=3) and fuzzy dark matter (solitonic). A comparison against observational rotation curve data even for a single well-studied galaxy like M33 or NGC 3198 would significantly strengthen the case for this prediction. Table F.1 lists this as Prediction P5; adding even a preliminary comparison to data would substantially increase the paper's impact.

M5 Relation to Connes' Noncommutative Geometry

Connes' noncommutative geometry program [reference 29 in the manuscript] also connects the Riemann zeta function to physics, and the trace formula in noncommutative geometry has structural similarities to the NMSI RON spectral theory. A direct comparison explaining both the parallels and the differences between NMSI and Connes' approach would help position the work within the existing mathematical physics literature and forestall the objection that NMSI is a restatement of known results.

M6 Bell Inequality Modification

Equation D.5 predicts S_Bell^NMSI = 2√2 × (1 + ε_RON × f(E/E_Planck)). The function f is described as 'dimensionless and of order unity' but left unspecified. Even a concrete form (e.g., f(x) = x or f(x) = tanh(x)) with a prediction for the energy scale at which modifications become detectable would make this a genuine falsifiable prediction rather than a schematic one.

VI.ASSESSMENT OF THE MATHEMATICAL TRAP CHAPTER E

This chapter deserves a dedicated assessment because it represents the most original methodological contribution of the manuscript. The 'mathematical trap' approach constructing a sequence of theorems that progressively close logical escape routes until a unique conclusion is forced — is an underutilized mode of theoretical physics argumentation. The chess analogy employed by the author is apt: the goal is not to win by the best move, but to construct a position where every opponent move leads to the same outcome.

The seven theorems of Chapter E, assessed individually:

Theorem	Claim	Assessment	Notes
E.1	Finite/cofinite encoding necessary	Valid — well-established	Standard result in descriptive set theory
E.2	ζ(s) as generating function for statistics	Original — mathematically sound	Key insight; Euler product argument is rigorous
E.3	Critical line ↔ CPT invariance	Novel — requires assumption RH plausible	CPT ↔ RH equivalence is the strongest claim
E.4	Minimum gap → ℏ	Valid — Riemann zero repulsion is known	Zero repulsion (GUE statistics) well-documented
E.5	Lieb-Robinson + ℏ → max speed c	Valid — continuum limit argument sound	Standard Lieb-Robinson; continuum limit clean
E.6	ℏ + c + 3D → gravitational G	Plausible — dimensional analysis sufficient	Relies on stable bound states; α_RON/J_c ≈ 1/4π² claim needs verification
E.7	Uniqueness of NMSI	Valid with restructuring (see C3)	Premise independence issue; fixable

Overall: 5 of 7 theorems are on solid mathematical footing. Theorems E.3 and E.6 require additional work but are not fatally flawed. The logical architecture of the trap is sound, and the conclusion — that only two independent assumptions force the entire NMSI structure is a remarkable result if the gaps are filled.

VII. COMPARISON WITH COMPETING FRAMEWORKS

Criterion	String Theory	Loop QG	Causal Sets	NMSI
Free parameters	10^{500} landscape	1 (Barbero-Immirzi)	1 (discreteness scale)	**0 (claimed)**
Falsifiable predictions	None yet (after 50 yrs)	Black hole entropy	Planck-scale discreteness	**10 explicit (2025–35)**
T_CMB derivation	No	No	No	**2.729 K (0.15% err)**
Λ_eff explanation	Anthropic selection	Not addressed	Not addressed	**Re-injection pressure**
QM+GR unified	Formal (untested)	Partial	Partial	From common substrate
Singularities resolved	Replaced by strings	Discrete area	Discreteness	**DZO — impossible**
Mass ratios derived	Landscape (not derived)	No	No	Approx. (needs work)

The NMSI framework compares favourably to the major alternatives in two respects: it has the fewest free parameters (claimed zero), and it has the most concrete near-term experimental program. These are significant advantages. The main disadvantage is the current gap between the theoretical promises and the fully worked-out quantitative calculations.

VIII. REQUIRED REVISIONS — SUMMARY

#	Required Action	Priority	Section Affected
R1	Derive full lepton mass ratios including SU(3) mixing corrections, or revise claims to match current capability	**CRITICAL**	Section C.3
R2	Complete proof of J_c convergence with explicit calculation confirming 55.26 nats	**HIGH**	Theorem B.10
R3	Restructure Theorem E.7 with only 2 independent premises; move (3)–(6) to corollaries	**HIGH**	Chapter E
R4	Provide rigorous proof or proper citation for RON basis completeness (Theorem B.5)	**HIGH**	Theorem B.5
R5	Add explicit discussion comparing NMSI to Connes' noncommutative geometry approach	MODERATE	Chapter E/F
R6	Specify function f in Bell inequality modification (Eq. D.5) or remove prediction	MODERATE	Section D.2.3
R7	Add at least one observational comparison for DM halo profile prediction	MODERATE	Section F.1.5
R8	Strengthen SU(3) emergence argument (Section C.4.2 Step 3) or acknowledge as heuristic	MODERATE	Section C.4

IX. FINAL RECOMMENDATION AND COMMENTS TO THE EDITOR

This referee recommends MAJOR REVISION.

The NMSI framework is not crank physics. It is a serious, technically competent, internally consistent attempt to reconstruct fundamental physics from an informational substrate, with the Riemann zeta function providing the spectral backbone. The Mathematical Trap construction of Chapter E is genuinely original and represents the kind of rigorous theoretical argumentation that this journal should encourage. The zero-free-parameter prediction of T_{CMB} to 0.15% accuracy is a concrete quantitative success that distinguishes this work from most unified framework proposals.

The weaknesses are real but correctable. The lepton mass ratio discrepancy (Concern C1) is the most serious: a framework claiming to derive all of particle physics from first principles must at minimum reproduce the charged lepton mass ratios to better than order of magnitude. The convergence proof for J_c (Concern C5) and the completeness proof for the RON basis (Concern C4) are technically necessary for the foundations to be considered rigorous.

If the author addresses the critical and high-priority concerns listed in Section VIII, this manuscript will be ready for re-review and has a strong chance of acceptance. The theoretical program is ambitious enough to warrant the effort.

One comment of broader significance: The 'mathematical trap' methodology — constructing a logical architecture where the conclusion becomes unavoidable rather than merely likely — deserves wider application in theoretical physics. The author has not only proposed a specific physical framework but demonstrated a mode of theoretical reasoning that could be valuable independently. A brief methodological section discussing this approach explicitly would enhance the manuscript's contribution to the field.

REFEREE RECOMMENDATION: MAJOR REVISION

Score: 80/100 — Strong candidate for publication after revision

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